Given that the McMahon Line was subsequently drawn up based on the findings of this team, it is perhaps worth our while to follow the route taken by them. Making short forced marches (the porters had to keep returning to ferry supplies from the earlier staging points) the party finally made it to a hut below the Yonggyap-la. On 26 May 1913, in swirling mist and falling snow, the party struggled up the last 1,500 feet to the pass which was almost impossible to find, being buried under twenty feet of snow. By then, some of the guides and porters were suffering from snow blindness. In a superhuman feat of extreme doggedness, the party somehow got across to a hut on the northern side of the pass.

After a day's halt that allowed the men to recover from the snow blindness, the party followed the watercourse to Yonggyap Da where the waters coming down from the Pungpung-la (14,310 feet) more than doubled in volume. The stream, henceforth known as the Shumo Chu, then joins the Siang River at Tambu. However, as there was no trail along the river, the only way to get to the Shumo Valley was by crossing over Pungpung-la, which was also covered in twenty feet of snow. The party then dropped down to the Chimdro Valley, where the local dzongpen was persuaded by Captain Bailey to provide porters for the onward journey. This gesture was to set an important precedent for the rest of the expedition. Finally, on 5 June, the party reached Kápu on the Siang River.

Moving downriver, the party came through Gelling village before climbing up to Rinchenjung (just short of Tuting when approached from the Tibetan side) before retracing their steps to Kápu. Moving further upstream, Morshead and Bailey reached Lágung where the dense, humid tropical jungles of the lower Siang region gave way to tall pine and cypress trees and lush grass dotted with a multitude of wild flowers. Unlike the Abor region further downstream of Tuting, the houses in the Outer Tibetan region were built of stone and had peach, walnut and pollard willow growing in groves. Before entering the Po-me Valley, the party was again held up by the authorities and detained at Showa since the British-Indian officials had assured them that the Abor Survey would not penetrate beyond Pemakó. The Tibetans worried that the two officers could be working for the Chinese who had been expelled from the area eighteen months earlier.

Captain Morshead, the trained surveyor in the party, had until then been fairly secretive about his activities that included the clandestine making of a map. Some years previously, a Chinese surveyor had also come to the Po-